

The Missing Wheel: answers

Grade 4 · 12 points. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. Three weeks. (1 point)

Finding information (RL.4.1). A detail to find in the first paragraph before the child moves on to reading between the lines.

2. It snapped in two (it rolled right off the ramp when he tested it). (1 point)

Finding information (RL.4.1). Establishing the problem the rest of the story depends on.

3. Upset, embarrassed or discouraged. Evidence, for example: he stood with his arms folded, he mumbled, he did not look up. (2 points)

Inference (RL.4.1). The story never says how Ben felt. The child works it out from his actions and gives the clue that proves it.

4. She was nervous or torn, because it was her only spare wheel and she might need it herself. (2 points)

Inference (RL.4.1). A small action that reveals a hidden thought. The child connects it to the earlier detail about the “only one”.

5. Shook slightly (because she was nervous). (1 point)

Word meaning (RL.4.4). Using the surrounding sentences to work out what a word means.

6. No. It was her only spare wheel, she bit her lip, and her hand trembled. She was only pretending it did not matter. (2 points)

Inference (RL.4.1). What someone says and what they feel can be different. The child finds the clues that show the difference.

7. He was thankful and wanted to repay her. He wrote “I owe you one wheel. Maybe two” and drew a smiling car. (2 points)

Inference (RL.4.1). Reading a character’s feelings from what they do and write.

8. A (1 point)

Summarizing (RL.4.2). A theme is the big idea behind the whole story, not just one event.